WEEKLY PROGRESS REPORT

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Week Ending: Week 02	**Date of Submission:** August 20, 2026

I. OVERVIEW

This week, the primary focus was on exploring the foundational concepts of Internet of Things (IoT) hardware perception layer architecture, and the rise of embedded systems as emerging technologies [22, 26]. The activities centered on analyzing the physical and network characteristics of edge IoT devices [26], comparing custom flat circuit designs with prefabricated System on Modules (SOMs) and Single Board Computers (SBCs) [7, 8, 9], and understanding the educational and industrial ecosystems that drive local product engineering [11, 12, 13].

1.5 Years → 1 Month	1,000 — 10,000	< 500 INR
Development Speedup Time-to-market reduction utilizing System on Modules (SOM) [8, 9]	**Optimal Annual Vol.** Recommended production sweet-spot for SOM integration [10]	**Oximeter Target Cost** COVID-19 pulse oximeter local production benchmark [14]

II. ACHIEVEMENTS

1. IoT Device and Perception Layer Architecture Fundamentals

Studied the basic architecture of IoT devices, which are defined as pieces of hardware—such as sensors, actuators, gadgets, appliances, or machines—programmed for specific applications [26]. These physical objects sense real-world phenomena and contain an integrated CPU, network adapter, and firmware [26]. To function over a network and transmit data to the Internet or other networks, they are typically connected to a Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (DHCP) server to acquire an IP address [26]. This architectural layer forms the critical perception layer of IoT [26].

2. Deep Dive into Sensors, Actuators, and Microcontrollers

Analyzed the roles of various hardware components that interface with the physical world, exploring sensors such as temperature, humidity, ultrasonic, air quality, gyroscope, and accelerometer sensors [26]. Studied how actuators play a vital role alongside sensors in physical world interaction [26]. Additionally, reviewed microcontrollers of various processing widths, including 8-bit, 16-bit, and 32-bit units, which serve as the computational core in edge devices [26].

3. Single-Board Computer (SBC) Analysis: Raspberry Pi

Evaluated the RaspberryPi asa low-cost, low-power consumption, credit card-sized single-board computer that provides full computing facilities on a single board [26]. Explored its versatility in diverse application domains, including robotics, home automation, security systems, and its utility as a portable PC or learning tool for IoT development [26].

4. Commercial Electronics Development: SOMs vs. Flat Design

Analyzed commercial electronic designmethodologies.Traditional flat design from scratch requires selecting individual ICs, resistors, transistors, and VLSI chipsets, followed by drawing complex circuit diagrams—a process that typically takes 6 to 18 months [8]. In contrast, leveraging a System on Module (SOM) or System on Chip (SOC), which integrates the processor, random access memory (RAM), and input/output (I/O) ports on a compact 30 cm by 30 cm motherboard, reduces the development time to just one month [7, 8, 9]. Phytec, as an alpha partner to SOC manufacturers like NXP, Texas Instruments, and Renesas, designs and provides these SOMs to support pre-launch hardware testing, such as TI's AM64X SOC evaluation kits [7, 8]. Standard Single Board Computers (SBCs) built around these SOMs can handle 30% to 40% of the customer's application out-of-the-box [7, 9].

5. Embedded Systems Ecosystem & Fullstack IoT Training

Studiedtheoperational verticalsofembeddedtechnology companies like Phytec, which include Embedded Hardware (SOMs and SBCs), Embedded Software (Board Support Packages, device drivers, compilers, and OS customization), OEM/ODM (product branding and licensing on a shared IP royalty basis), and Capacity Building (upskilling electronic engineering graduates) [11, 12]. Understood the structure of the 6-month 'Embedded Fullstack IoT / Industrial IoT Analyst' training curriculum, which covers six comprehensive modules: Embedded C programming, ARM MCU programming, Linux internals, Linux porting, Linux device drivers, and the Yocto operating system [17]. This program utilizes a hands-on 'employer-employee' training style and requires solid proficiency in C and Python [17].

III. CHALLENGES AND HURDLES

1. Navigating Traditional Flat Design Complexity

Encountered conceptual challengesin understanding theintricate workflow of traditional flat electronic design, where engineers must develop circuits from scratch using individual transistors, resistors, ICs, and VLSI chipsets [8]. This traditional approach is highly resource-intensive and demands 6 to 18 months of intensive hardware engineering before software can be ported [8, 9].

2. Embedded Software Stack and BSP Customization

Faced complexity in understanding howhardware components integrate with embedded software. Specifically, studied the challenges of designing Board Support Packages (BSPs) to interface physical Ethernet ports with industrial RS485 communication protocols [12]. Navigating the multi-layered software stack—from low-level device drivers and compilers to high-level operating system customization like Yocto OS—remains a major technical hurdle that requires deep learning [12, 17].

IV. LEARNING RESOURCES

1. Videographic and Podcast Materials:
• *Podcast Episode 12:* "Rise of Embedded Systems and IoT as Emerging Technologies 2023" featuring industry insights from Mr. Arun Kumar Singh, Director of Sales at Phytec Embedded Private Limited [1, 6].
• *Educational Video Lecture:* "What is the IoT Devices? | IoT Devices & Platform | Applications of IoT" published by upSkill Campus [26].

2. Technical Documentation and Course Syllabus:
• *Embedded Fullstack IoT Analyst Curriculum:* Syllabus detailing the 6 core training modules: Embedded C, ARM MCU, Linux internals, Linux porting, Linux device drivers, and the Yocto operating system [17].
• *SBC & SOM Technical Specifications:* Reference materials on Phytec SBC layouts, Texas Instruments AM64X SOC portals, and general microprocessor architectures [7, 8].

V. LESSONS LEARNED

1. Strategic Reduction in Time-to-Market

Learned that leveraging System on Modules (SOMs) is a highly efficient business and engineering strategy. Rather than developing hardware from scratch, using a SOM reduces the prototyping timeline from over a year to just one month, enabling rapid software porting and pilot testing [8, 9]. This makes hardware development highly cost-effective for annual production volumes of 1,000 to 10,000 units, such as medical X-ray scanners [10, 11].

2. Shift from Academic Lectures to Industry Hands-On Learning

Recognized the value of the 'employer-employee' training methodology over the traditional 'student-teacher' approach [17]. Hands-on, practical execution is vital for mastering complex subjects like Linux device drivers and Yocto OS porting, with a strong foundation in C and Python being the essential prerequisites [17].

3. Socio-Economic Importance of Domestic Hardware Competency

Gained a profound understanding of why domestic hardware design is critical. Electronics represent the second-largest import category in India after oil and gas, draining significant foreign reserves [14]. Geopolitical conflicts or crises can leave a nation helpless if it lacks local design capabilities [14, 18, 19]. For instance, during the pandemic, simple devices like pulse oximeters (which cost under 500 rupees to produce) had to be heavily imported because not a single domestic company manufactured them locally [14]. Building capacity and upskilling local electronic graduates is essential to support the 'Make in India' and national GDP development goals [13, 14, 15].

VI. NEXT WEEK'S GOALS

1. Hands-On Single-Board Computer Deployment:
• Configure and set up a physical Raspberry Pi single-board computer [26].
• Flash the operating system and utilize the device as a portable PC to gain familiarity with its peripheral interfaces [26].

2. Basic GPIO Programming and Sensor Interfacing:
• Interface physical sensors (specifically temperature, humidity, and ultrasonic sensors) to the Raspberry Pi [26].
• Write Python-based scripts to retrieve and analyze physical world data, aligning with Module 1 & 2 concepts [17, 26].

3. Board Support Package (BSP) Fundamentals:
• Study the basic integration of communication interfaces, focusing on how Ethernet and RS485 communication protocols are established at the software level [5, 12].

VII. ADDITIONAL COMMENTS

The activities of Week 02 have highlighted that while India possesses highly educated youth with degrees, there is a critical gap in employable hands-on skills regarding product design and development [13]. Participating in Super 50 programs or Center of Excellence initiatives (like the 500-crore Skill Development Institute in Bhubaneswar) represents a vital stepping stone [15]. Developing local manufacturing and engineering competency is not merely an academic exercise, but a national strategic imperative [14, 18, 19].

> **Key Takeaway:** Developing hardware competency reduces time-to-market from 18 months to 1 month [8, 9] and fosters socio-economic resilience by minimizing dependence on foreign electronic imports, which constitute the country's second-largest import expenditure [14].